

co-branded card will still net you some benefit.

BUY NOW, REGRET LATER

Oops! We meant to say – Buy now, Pay Later. While the concept of paying for purchases later has been around for a long time thanks to Credit Cards, the same offers are slowly trickling down into Debit Cards. Not all banks' Debit Cards support EMI (Equated Monthly Instalments) payments but the popular banks do. However, their rising popularity has led to a new class of payments services and cards forming.



Buy Now Pay Later or BNPL is very similar to Credit Cards wherein you only pay a small amount as a downpayment while making the purchase and then the remainder of the payment can either be paid in a series of interest-free EMIs or as a lumpsum amount. Compared to Credit Cards, BNPL services are usually more flexible in terms of tenure. Credit Cards usually have a lot of hidden charges that only pop up when you receive your bill whereas BNPL services usually don't have that.

What's the catch then? Well, there isn't a points rewards system attached to BNPL services. At least, not in their current avatar. Getting approved for a BNPL account is also simpler and the interest charged on missed payments is also lesser. However, most of the requirements for BNPL are similar to Credit Cards in the sense that you should be salaried or willing to have a lien placed on funds in your bank account, be in a major city or have some credit history. There are several services in the market such as Amazon Pay Later, Simpl, LazyPay and ZestMoney among others.

AIMING FOR A REBOUND

We've already covered the concept of cashback in the first two sections about Credit Cards and BNPL services. Those are the mechanisms by which you get a portion of your money back but did you know how to hunt for places that have cashback offers? There are literally hundreds of e-commerce stores once you consider all the different niches and a lot of them are running hundreds of offers at any given time. If only there were a few aggregator websites that took the pain of collecting all the currently available offers and arranging them in an easily searchable manner.

We're, of course, talking about cashback aggregators. A couple of years ago, coupon aggregator websites were a huge thing. Nowadays, the coupons are usually integrated into the e-commerce portals themselves right before you get to the payment gateway, so there's little need for coupon websites to exist. Of course, secret coupon codes exist and getting them is immensely difficult. Unfortunately, e-commerce websites are also great at identifying abuse of secret codes and putting a stop to them immediately. Also, most codes have limited usage or some form of identity authentication so that they can only be used by certain individuals. For example, you can only use employee discount codes using an employee account. Yet, coupon sites continue to exist and they do land some decent deals every now and then.



Cashback aggregators, on the other hand, are the evolution of coupon websites. Websites such as MagicPin, CouponDunia, NearBuy and GoPaisa have several sections that host curated offers which also include cashback offers. GoPaisa and

CouponDunia, have the most amount of offers among all the other websites. MagicPin and Nearbuy also list offers from physical stores as opposed to the other websites which focus primarily on e-commerce offers.

GET A HELPING HAND

Let's say that visiting a deal aggregator website, then finding out which of your cards has the best discount offer, followed by hunting additional coupons to sweeten the deal seems to be too much of a hassle. Especially when you have a lot of different websites and services to cover. We wouldn't fault you for wanting to hire a personal shopping assistant to do all of these things, because it really does feel like a lot needs to be done to save money.



What if a simple tool did half of the work for you? This is where comparison websites help. There are several websites online that act as price aggregators and pull in data from as many Indian websites as possible to give you the best deals. Let's say that you're looking to buy a laptop, you could check out our website (digit.in) for that product and if present, we'll show you the latest price from all the major e-commerce stores. While our website does a tonne of things including providing you with the latest news and reviews about the newest gadget on the block, there are other websites that do just price comparison and nothing else.

Some of these websites have browser extensions that hunt for better deals across competing websites and even auto-apply coupon codes to avail of an additional discount. All this convenience comes at the simple